

Ikigai Mapping Worksheet

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"What makes your life worth living?"

Ikigai is a Japanese concept — your reason for being. It sits at the intersection of four things: what you love, what you're good at, what the world needs, and what you can be paid for. This worksheet walks you through each quadrant with specific prompts designed for people at inflection points.

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

1. Set aside 30–60 minutes in a quiet space.
2. Work through each quadrant fully before moving to the next.
3. In Part 4, look for overlaps — the intersections reveal your ikigai.
4. Don't edit yourself. Write what's true, not what sounds good.



Work through the four sections on the following pages, then return here to find your intersections.

What You Love · What You're Good At

◆ WHAT YOU LOVE

Activities, subjects, and experiences that give you energy — not drain it.

01 When do you lose track of time?

Think about the last time hours felt like minutes.

02 What topics do you find yourself reading about for no reason?

Not for work. Not because you should. Just because.

03 What would you do if money weren't a factor?

Don't censor this. Write the honest answer.

04 What did you love doing as a child that you've set aside?

Sometimes our earliest loves are the clearest signal.

◆ WHAT YOU'RE GOOD AT

Your genuine strengths — not just your trained skills or job title.

01 What do people consistently come to you for?

Notice patterns in what others seek from you.

02 What feels effortless to you that seems hard for others?

The things you take for granted are often your greatest strengths.

03 What have you gotten better at through every chapter of your life?

Skills that have followed you across roles and contexts.

04 What would your closest friends say you're best at?

Write it as if they were speaking directly.

What the World Needs · What You Can Be Paid For

◆ WHAT THE WORLD NEEDS

Where your contribution creates real value for others — not what you think you should do.

01 What problems do you see that others seem to walk past?

The issues that bother you most may be pointing at your purpose.

02 Who do you most want to help, and what do they need?

Be specific — not 'everyone' but a real person or group.

03 What would you fight for, even if no one was watching?

Values revealed under pressure are often the most honest.

04 If you could change one thing about the world, what would it be?

And how does your specific background connect to that change?

◆ WHAT YOU CAN BE PAID FOR

The sustainable economic dimension of purpose — where your gifts meet real demand.

01 What have you been paid for in the past that felt meaningful?

Not just tolerable — genuinely worthwhile.

02 What skills or knowledge do people value enough to pay for?

Include both formal credentials and informal expertise.

03 What could you offer that would fill a gap in the market?

Where does your 'love' and 'good at' meet unmet need?

04 What would a sustainable income look like in your next chapter?

What does 'enough' actually mean for you?

Finding Your Intersection

Look back at your answers in all four sections. Where do you see the most overlap? Use these prompts to synthesize.

THE ACTIVITIES THAT APPEAR IN BOTH 'LOVE' AND 'GOOD AT':

THE NEED I SEEM MOST DRAWN TO ADDRESS:

THE VERSION OF 'PAID FOR' THAT FEELS MOST ALIGNED:

My ikigai — in one sentence:

One action I can take this week toward this:

WANT TO GO DEEPER?

This worksheet is a starting point. If you'd like to work through your ikigai with a coach who has navigated this herself, book a free discovery call at laurenfine.com

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